

MICHAEL (MIKE) GIBSON

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University of Maryland
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Last Update: November 2024
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Agricultural and Resource Economics University of Maryland, College Park	May 2027 (expected)
M.S. in Agricultural and Resource Economics University of Maryland, College Park	May 2025
M.S. in Economics Tufts University	May 2018
B.A. in Economics, Wheaton College (Massachusetts)	May 2016

RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics, Agricultural Economics, Applied Microeconomics

WORKING PAPERS

Manuscripts may be available at mtgibson.github.io; selected paper abstracts are available at the end.

1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. **Gibson, M.** “When Improving Agricultural Productivity Helps or Hurts: Sectoral Correlation and Growth Effects of Productivity Shocks”
2. **Gibson, M.** “Harvesting the Toll: Productivity Loss from Suicide in U.S. Agriculture [Joint with Ariel Listo]”

TECHNICAL WRITING

1. “[Introduction to randomized evaluations](#)” (Joint with Anja Sautmann, contributions from Laura Feeney and Claire Walsh) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
2. “[The elements of a randomized evaluations](#)” (Joint with Anja Sautmann, contributions from Laura Feeney and Claire Walsh) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
3. “[Survey programming](#)” (Joint with Wim Louw, contributions from Kathryn McDermott) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
4. “[Data quality checks](#)” (Contributions from Ben Morse) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
5. “[Implementation monitoring](#)” (Contributions from Arnesh Chowdhury, Maya Duru, Lipika Kapoor, Sarah Kopper, Wim Louw, Tithee Mukhopadhyay, and Clare Sachsse) Jameel Poverty Action Lab

6. [“Resources for conducting remote surveys”](#) (Joint with Sarah Kopper, contributions from Marifatul Amalia, Saurabh Bhajibhakare, Putul Gupta, and Wim Louw) Jameel Poverty Action Lab

INVITED TALKS

1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) 2024 Winter Graduate Seminars

2024

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

Western Economic Association International 99th Annual Conference, Seattle

2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF) Fellow, World Bank

Dr. Alaka Holla & Dr. Anja Sautmann

Jun. 2023 - current

Research Assistant, University of Maryland

Dr. Erik Lichtenberg & Dr. Lars Olson

Dec. 2023 - Sept 2024

Dr. Lori Lynch

May. 2022 - Jun. 2023

Masters Thesis, Tufts University

Dr. Melissa McInerney

Sept. 2017 - May 2018

[Contingency Plans: The Effects of Dependent Coverage Mandate on the Contingent Workforce Decisions of Young Adults](#)

Research Assistant, Tufts University

Dr. Jenny Aker

Sept. 2017 - May 2018

[Harvesting the rain: The adoption of environmental technologies in the Sahel](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of record, University of Maryland, College Park

Undergraduate level

AREC Special Course: Harvesting History—How agriculture built America

Spring 2027

Description: From the first plow to precision agriculture, this course explores how farming built—and continues to transform—America. Students examine the role of agriculture in shaping communities, economies, and ecosystems across America’s history. Topics range from colonial and industrial agriculture to biotechnology, GMOs, and the rise of corporate agribusiness. Emphasis is placed on how agricultural practices influence environmental sustainability, biodiversity, and human health.

I was responsible for the creation of all course materials and first instance of the course, administered in Spring 2027.

Teaching Assistant, University of Maryland, College Park

Undergraduate-level

AREC 241: Environment, Economics and Policy; Dr. Lars Olson	Fall 2024
AREC 280: Big Data and Climate Change; Dr. Lars Olson	Fall 2023
ECON/AREC 481: Environmental Economics; rating: 3.5/4 (N=7) Dr. Robertson Williams, III	Spring 2022
AREC 240: Introduction to Environmental Economics; rating: 3.4/4 (N=17) Dr. Robertson Williams, III	Spring 2022
AREC 365: World Hunger, Population, and Food; rating: 3.3/4 (N=3) Dr. Ken Leonard	Fall 2021

Head Teaching Assistant, Tufts University

Undergraduate-level

EC 05: Introduction to Economics	Fall 2017, Spring 2018
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Teaching Assistant, Tufts University

Undergraduate-level

EC 05: Introduction to Economics	Fall 2016, Spring 2017
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Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, Wheaton College (Massachusetts)

Macroeconomics I	Spring 2015
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AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Bessie H. DeVault Best Prospectus Award, University of Maryland, AREC	2025
Paper Accelerator Grant, (\$5,000) Institute for Humane Studies	2023
Dean's Fellowship, University of Maryland	2021

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Reviewer, American Journal of Agricultural Economics	2025-
Graduate Representative for AREC, University of Maryland , College Park	2023, 2024
Graduate Student Government Member, University of Maryland, College Park	2023, 2024
Global Applications International Network Mentor	2021, 2022, 2024

LANGUAGE AND SKILLS

Language: English (native), Spanish (intermediate), French (beginner)
Software: Stata, R, MATLAB, ArcGIS, $\text{\LaTeX}$

SELECTED ABSTRACTS

1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

This paper documents the joint impacts of an export restriction and anti-drug trafficking policy on municipalities in avocado-producing states. I show theoretically that the policies could increase the profitability of avocado production in municipalities but expose them to cartel exploitation. Using a difference-in-difference approach, I show that after the policies are enacted, high-suitability municipalities expand avocado production yet experience only short-term income benefits. Consistent with the model, these municipalities are roughly 24% more likely to face cartel occupation after the policies are enacted. I rule out several alternative explanations and mechanisms for the lack of long-term benefits.